

THE CASE OF WILLIAM GOULDSTONE.

The Home Secretary has addressed a letter to the Sheriff of Essex, Mr. J. Oxley Parker, signifying the Queen's commands that the sentence of death passed upon William Gouldstone for the murder of his five children at Walthamstow, be respited until Monday, the 8th of October, in order that inquiry may be made as to the prisoner's sanity. The execution was fixed for Monday next.

At the request of the Home Secretary, Dr. Clarke, of London, and Dr. Orringe, of the Criminal Lunatic Asylum at Broadmoor, have visited Chelmsford Prison to examine the convict William Gouldstone, lying under sentence of death for the murder of his five children at Walthamstow, with a view to reporting upon his state of mind. Dr. Clarke and Dr. Orringe, who spent six or seven hours with the convict, will make their report direct to Sir William Harcourt. During the week Gouldstone has been visited by several of his relatives. He pays diligent attention to the ministrations of the prison chaplain, the Rev. W. Faithfull Lumley.

The *British Medical Journal* says:—"We are informed that the Home Secretary intends to commute the sentence on the convict Gouldstone to penal servitude for life, the evidence of insanity being sufficient to justify a modification of the sentence."